

Qualifications for Membership Checklist:

Congratulations! on your decision to apply for membership into **Golden Spike Lodge № 6 Free and Accepted Masons of Utah.**

Freemasonry is one of the finest fraternities the world has ever known. May you enjoy the pursuit into this *Ancient and Honorable* Fraternity; as much as countless others have before you.

Do you meet the Ancient Prerequisites?

Every candidate applying for the degrees in Masonry must:

- ☐ **First.** Be a man, free born.
- ☐ **Second.** Have the senses of a man.
- ☐ **Third.** Be a believer in the Grand Architect of the Universe.
- ☐ **Fourth.** Be of mental worth, capable of reading and writing.
- ☐ **Fifth.** Have a record of a moral upright life.
- ☐ **Sixth.** Possess physical ability to earn a livelihood.
- ☐ **Seventh.** Be able to conform substantially to the forms and ceremonies of Masonry, and to be instructed in its mysteries.

Do you meet the additional Prerequisites set by the Grand Lodge of Free and Accepted Masons of Utah?

Every candidate applying for the degrees in Masonry must:

- ☐ Be at least **(18) eighteen years** of age.
- ☐ Be an actual resident of the State of Utah for at least **(06) six months**.
- ☐ Be an actual resident of the jurisdiction of the Lodge at least **(06) six months**.
- ☐ Be recommended in writing by two members of *this Lodge*; who shall have personally known you for at least **(06) six months'** time, previous to submitting a petition for membership.

Every question on the petition must be answered before it can properly be received by the Lodge.

Typically, the process is as follows:

The applicant fills out a petition. The petition asks for two sponsors, one of which has to have known the applicant for 6 months. If you do not know anyone in the lodge you can meet and talk with the officers, they can usually find sponsors or act as sponsors themselves.

The petition is read at the lodge during the next business meeting, which for many lodges is during the first week of the month. A committee is formed to investigate the candidate. The petition also asks for two character references.

The committee meets with the candidate to answer questions, ascertain that he meets the criteria for membership, and find out a little about him. This is not a “grilling session,” but rather a friendly and casual chat to make certain that the candidate has been properly informed about Masonry and was not improperly solicited. The committee also contacts the character references listed on the petition (typically asking if they know any reason why the candidate should not be accepted, etc.)

The committee reports back to the lodge during the next business meeting and the candidate is voted on. If accepted, someone from the lodge (often the Secretary) contacts the candidate and informs him that he has been accepted and schedules a date for the Entered Apprentice degree.

IMPORTANT INFORMATION FOR PETITIONER

The question of becoming a Freemason is a matter for very serious consideration, and since you have expressed desire to be a member, we deem it advisable that you should be informed on certain points which may affect your decision to apply.

In all ages, Freemasonry has insisted that men should come to its doors unsolicited and entirely of their own free will and accord. Moreover, those joining in the hope of selfish personal gain will be bitterly disappointed.

Freemasonry has for its foundation the great basic principles of the Fatherhood of God and the Brotherhood of Man. No atheist can be made a Mason.

Freemasonry is not in any way an insurance society nor does it provide benefits in case of sickness or death. In a correct and broad sense it is a charitable association, but it only extends such charity as it feels willing and able to grant, not as a matter or right to the recipient, but in its desire to do good and exemplify its moral teachings. The yearly dues are entirely inadequate to permit other than temporary assistance to a member or his family in case of need.

A universal custom requires that, through oral instruction, certain portions of the work is to be memorized after each degree and before a candidate is advanced.

Every Member is expected to pay promptly the annual dues fixed by his Lodge.

FEES

Petitions for the degrees shall be accompanied by a sum not less than the fee prescribed in its By-laws for the Entered Apprentice Degree. If you so desire, you may pay in full , the -Total fees for the three degrees, by submitting those fees with your petition, or utilize the Installment plan. Each fee must be paid in advance, previous to accepting your petition or receiving each degree.

Total fee for the three degrees: **\$ 225.00.**

Installment plan:

\$ 75.00 with Petition,

\$ 75.00 before receiving Fellow Craft degree,

\$ 75.00 before receiving Master Mason degree.

After becoming a Master Mason,

the annual dues are **\$137.00**, payable in advance.